

DealParser AI — Product Brief

The ideation, analysis, and research behind this was conducted by the author. Claude and other AI tools were only utilized to help organize, refine, format and present the research.

1. Product Summary

DealParser AI is a self serve, pay as you go web app that uses AI to convert messy rent roll, T-12, and offering memorandum PDFs into structured, exportable pro forma models, built for small and independent real estate investors who currently rely on manual data entry.

Live V1 UI demo: <https://dealparserai.vercel.app/>

**Backend build is in progress*

2. Problem Statement

Sellers of residential real estate send potential buyers rent roll and T-12 documents in varying, non-standardized formats. Investors must manually transfer this data into their own Excel sheets or investment software — a process that is error-prone and laborious for every deal under consideration. Small, boutique, or independent real estate investors cannot afford large-scale commercial real estate software, nor do they require its full feature set to analyze the number of deals they review.

This creates a meaningful opportunity: because every property on the market can draw analysis from multiple competing investors before a single buyer closes, the total volume of deal analyses run each year far exceeds the number of properties sold. Real estate is inherently competitive, and the investor who underwrites faster can bid faster — a decisive advantage in hot markets. Yet the current manual, copy/paste-heavy process elongates the time it takes to even reach a go/no-go decision, well before an investor gets to the harder work of calculating net operating income, gross margins, vacancy rates, and building valuation.

3. Target Audience

Persona	Description
Primary	Solo investor, 1 to 2 deals a month, part of an estimated 300,000 person addressable market [1]
Secondary	More active investor or micro syndicate, higher monthly deal volume

4. Goals and Success Metrics

Phase	Focus
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Pilot (University of Wisconsin)	Parsing accuracy rate, participation rate, qualitative feedback
Post launch	Paying users by tier, Pay-As-You-Go to subscription conversion, monthly recurring revenue, actual cost per parse vs. \$0.22 modeled estimate

(Full KPI detail: Business Case, Success Metrics/KPIs)

5. Product Versions

	V1 (current, live demo)	V2 (planned)
Core function	Parses and calculates deal metrics from PDFs	Independently recalculates deal metrics using buyer's own assumptions
Output	Side by side comparison of source PDF vs. calculated results	Seller's claimed numbers shown alongside buyer's own recalculated numbers
Metrics calculated	OpEx, gross margin, cash on cash return, vacancy rate, NOI, cap rate, DSCR, IRR	Same, plus independently derived NOI and cap rate
Positioning	Document digitizer and verifier	Deal verification tool, flags discrepancies vs. seller claims
Build note	Live	Adds a calculation layer on the existing V1 schema, not a pipeline rewrite

6. How It Works (Parsing Pipeline)

1. Documents with a real text layer are extracted directly, at near zero cost
2. Scanned or low quality documents fall back to image based AI analysis
3. Extraction starts on the fastest, cheapest AI model (Haiku)
4. Automated validation checks the output
5. Only flagged documents escalate to a more capable, more expensive model (Sonnet/Opus)

This keeps both cost and turnaround time low without sacrificing accuracy.

7. Pricing

Tier	Price	Included
Pay-As-You-Go	\$15/deal	1 file
Light Sub	\$20/mo	7 files
Active Sub	\$50/mo	30 files

Payments processed via Stripe. (Margin detail: Business Case, Cost-Benefit Analysis)

8. Scope

In scope (V1):

- File upload: accepts rent roll, T-12, or offering memorandum (OM) PDFs (up to 25MB) via drag-and-drop or browse. OM support is a planned near-term addition to the current build, which today accepts rent roll/T-12 only.
- Side-by-side verification view: shown after upload, comparing the original source PDF against DealParser AI's extracted and calculated figures
- Deal dashboard: a "My Prospective Deals" view listing every parsed deal with property name, address, unit count, parse date, NOI, cap rate, and a status tag (Draft or Reviewed)
- Deal summary page, calculated per deal: Net Operating Income (annualized), Cap Rate (against purchase price), Cash-on-Cash Return (Year 1), DSCR (at a stated interest rate), 5-Year IRR (levered)
- Interest rate sensitivity table: shows how cap rate and cash-on-cash return shift across a $\pm 1.0\%$ interest rate swing from the base case
- Export: download as Excel (.xlsx) or as a PDF summary
- Account/login: basic user login, deals tied to an account
- Legal disclaimer: persistent footer disclaimer clarifying DealParser AI is a parsing/calculation tool, not financial, legal, or investment advice, and that users are responsible for verifying figures against source documents
- Pricing tiers (Pay-As-You-Go \$15/deal, Light Sub \$20/mo for 7 files, Active Sub \$50/mo for 30 files)

Out of scope (V1):

- Multi-file or batch upload (one PDF per upload only)
- Independent recalculation of seller-claimed figures using the buyer's own assumptions (V2)

9. Competitive Landscape

Split into two groups based on what they actually do: pure extraction competitors (matching V1) and full deal-verification or underwriting platforms (matching V2).

V1-equivalent competitors (extraction only):

Competitor	What it does	Pricing	Gap DealParser AI fills
RentRollIQ	Converts rent roll, T-12, and OM into one workbook with citation-level sourcing; closest direct competitor	\$19/file, \$49/mo for 25 files, \$149/mo for 100 files	No side by side verification; numbers not formula-linked after export; no deal history view
AcquiOS	Extracts rent roll/T-12 with citation-level sourcing into an existing Excel template in ~90 seconds	Team-based pricing	Doesn't serve single independent investors
QuickData.ai	Extracts rent rolls and T-12s into Excel via an add-in	\$99/user/mo, up to \$349 for premier tier	Requires onboarding, priced for teams
Docsumo	General-purpose document extraction, not real estate specific	Not disclosed	Business-centric, not investor-centric
PRODA.ai	Extracts and error-checks rent rolls from property management system exports (Yardi, MRI, RealPage)	Not disclosed	Built for larger businesses
Clik.ai	AutoUW engine spreads financials from raw documents	Not disclosed	Lender and commercial focused

V2-equivalent competitors (recalculation, verification, full underwriting):

Competitor	What it does	Pricing	Gap DealParser AI fills
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Syndicator.ai	All-in-one underwriting platform, scenario comparison, real-time SOFR/Treasury rate pulls	\$97/mo unlimited	Steep price for a self-starter; full suite most solo investors don't need
DealFlowPro	Broker-email-to-underwriting workflow with AI parsing, deal scoring, market intel	Free tier (3 analyses), then \$79 to \$399/mo	Most feature-robust competitor, but solo investors likely need only a fraction of the suite
DealWorthIt	Parses T-12s, rent rolls, and OMs, plus on/off-market deal sourcing	\$79, \$129, \$299/mo	Far more functional tool, but overbuilt for a user who only needs parsing
SurfaceAI	Compares extracted lease terms against underwriting models to flag mismatches, the closest "verify seller's claims" mechanic to V2	Demo required, no listed price	Positioning true V2 threat once pricing is known
DealCheck	Mobile-first deal screener with ARV/rent comps and return calculators; no AI parsing	\$0, \$10, \$20/mo	Most dangerous low end competitor on price, but doesn't parse documents at all
PropLab	Address-to-Maximum-Allowable-Offer calculator with lender-ready reports	Competitively priced	Flipper/wholesaler oriented, not multifamily, no AI parsing
ARGUS Enterprise	Legacy institutional standard for cash flow modeling	Enterprise pricing	Overkill and unaffordable for this buyer, but the industry benchmark

Bottom line: the space is crowded but not well served for this exact buyer. RentRollIQ is the closest real threat; everyone else is either priced for teams, missing AI parsing, or offering more suite than a solo investor doing one or two deals a month actually wants. The identified wedge is a pay-as-you-go, no-onboarding, side by side verification model, sitting between DealCheck's low price and RentRollIQ's feature set. The main competitive moat larger players hold is dedicated customer support for handling errors or AI mistakes, an area to watch as DealParser AI scales.

11. Stakeholders

Solo, founder led build (v0 for UI, Cursor with Claude in Agent Mode for backend). University of Wisconsin Real Estate Department is the key external stakeholder for the pilot. Scaling beyond MVP would require engineering, support, and legal or compliance resourcing, none currently funded.

12. Open Questions and Risks

- Final Pay-As-You-Go pricing pending pilot data
- Active Sub margin could dip to ~72.5% in a worst case document mix
- Go to market leans on one pilot for credibility
- Execution risk concentrated in one person

(Full risk detail: Business Case, Risk Assessment)

Citations

1. Turner Center for Housing Innovation, UC Berkeley (2024). Ownership and Management of Small Multifamily Rental Properties. <https://turnercenter.berkeley.edu/wp-content/uploads/2024/01/Ownership-and-Management-of-Small-Multifamily-Rental-Properties-January-2024-Final.pdf>